

pricing transparency, but it's still up to you to find the dealers who charge what they say they're going to charge and avoid the ones who will try to slip \$4,000 worth of fees under your nose.

And that leads us to our last point. You may want all the bells and whistles, but ask yourself, "Would I pay to add this if the car didn't already have it?" You can swap out the head unit to a unit with a screen, add a backup camera, upgrade the speakers, and even add adaptive cruise control to any car. I looked it up later, and adaptive cruise control costs about \$2,000 to add. I wouldn't pay \$2,000 for it, and I'm definitely glad I didn't pay \$4,000.

Food

We put out requests for episode ideas several times a year. The requests we get the most, by a landslide, are related to saving money on food. Because while housing and transportation decisions save you more overall, you're only making those decisions every couple of years. We make food decisions every day, multiple times a day, sometimes multiple times an hour . . . because food is delicious. Food also brings people together, it enriches the travel experience, it heightens the senses, and fuels creativity. It's why food is one of the top areas of impulse spending we all face and why the more intentional you are with your food choices, the better you'll get at values-based spending in all other areas. So how do we make those decisions that give us 80 percent results with 20 percent effort? That could be a book in and of itself (and maybe it will be???), but just in case that book never gets written, here are the two routines we practice every week to make sure we're being efficient with our food spending and use.

1. Meal Planning

When Travis and I (Jen) were paying off debt, we were renters and had paid off cars, so meal planning was the one change I made that had the biggest impact on my spending. Before that, I would just go to Publix, walk the aisles, and let the grocery store tell me what to make. I stuck to generic brands and looked at price per ounce, but I always came home with random things that I would use once and not know how to reuse. Things sat in my